Ashbourne Healthcare Group Limited

Minutes of a meeting of the Board of Directors

Held at Pinnacle House, Crown Street, Ipswich, on 14 May 2025 at 10.00 a.m.

Present: Helena Marsh (Non-executive Chair); Iqbal Rahman (Chief Executive); Lorna Keane (Chief Operating Officer); Daniel Pryce (General Counsel & Company Secretary).

In attendance: Sarah Whitfield (Partner, Whitfield Carter LLP) for item 3.

1. Apologies and quorum

Apologies were noted from the Group Finance Director. The Chair confirmed that a quorum was present and that the meeting was duly convened.

2. Maple Court — regulatory position

The COO updated the Board on the CQC inspection of Maple Court Care Home. The Board noted the Warning Notice issued on 6 March 2025 in respect of Regulation 12, the draft inspection report proposing an overall rating of 'Inadequate', and the Notice of Proposal dated 24 April 2025 to impose conditions on registration. The COO reported that the remedial action plan was substantially complete and that the Warning Notice compliance date of 30 April 2025 had been met.

3. Legal advice and strategy

Ms Whitfield of Whitfield Carter LLP advised the Board on the regulatory options. She confirmed that factual accuracy comments had been submitted on 3 April 2025 and that written representations against the Notice of Proposal were in preparation, to be filed by the deadline of 22 May 2025. The Board discussed the two proposed conditions and resolved to accept Proposed Condition 1 (monthly medicines-governance reporting) but to resist Proposed Condition 2 (restriction on admissions) as disproportionate, while preserving the right of appeal to the First-tier Tribunal.

4. Resolutions

- THAT the remedial action plan for Maple Court be approved and its completion noted;
- THAT Whitfield Carter LLP be instructed to file written representations resisting Proposed Condition 2 and accepting Proposed Condition 1 for a defined period;
- THAT the Chief Executive and General Counsel be authorised to settle the final form of the representations; and
- THAT a further update be brought to the Board following the Commission's Notice of Decision.

5. Close

There being no further business, the meeting closed at 11.05 a.m.

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Helena Marsh — Chair